Profile

Personal information

Name	James II, Shakespeare
Share different name	No
Birthdate	03/30/2009

Contact details

Email, Phone	shakespearejamesii@gmail.com, +1.347-942-3572, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent address	2235 Newbold Ave Bronx, NY, 10462-5107, USA

Demographics

Sex	Male
Pronouns	He/Him

Language

English	First Language

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status	U.S. citizen or U.S. national
Birthplace	New York, New York, United States of America 17 years US
SSN	XXX-XX-2671

Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested	No

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Family

Household

Independent	No
Parents	Married
Household	Both Parents

Parent 1

Father

Name	Mr. Shakespeare James
Email, Phone	sjames10462@gmail.com, +1.646-755-4915, Mobile
Occupation	Other, Financial analyst, Employed, Valuation Research Corporation
Education	Graduated from college/university Bachelors (2006), New York University, 70 Washington Sq S, Frnt 1, New York, NY, USA, CEEB: 2562

Parent 2

Mother

Name	Mrs. Vineetha James (V)
Occupation	Homemaker (full-time)
Education	Graduated from high/secondary school (or equivalent)

Siblings

Saurav James, Age 14

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Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Bronx High School of Science, 75 Bronx Science Blvd, Bronx, NY, USA, Public, CEEB: 333480 (09/2023 - 06/2027)

Progression	No change in progression
Graduation Date	06/2027

Colleges & universities

School	City University of New York: Lehman College, 250 Bedford Park Blvd W, Bronx, NY, USA, CEEB: 2312 Credit awarded directly by college (09/2025 - 08/2026)

Grades

Rank	na / 740
GPA	92.3 / 100, Unweighted

Current or most recent year courses

First semester	Second semester
CALC - AP calculus AB - (AP)	CALC - AP calculus AB - (AP)
ENVSCI - AP environmental science - (AP)	ENVSCI - AP environmental science - (AP)
MATH - AP statistics - (AP)	MATH - AP statistics - (AP)
ENG - AP english literature - (AP)	ENG - AP english literature - (AP)
SCI - AP psych - (AP)	SCI - AP psych - (AP)
PE/HLTH - Phys ed - (REG)	PE/HLTH - Phys ed - (REG)
HIST - AP comp gov - (AP)	HIST - AP comp gov - (AP)

Honors

3x MIT Beaverworks Certificates: Python, Serious Games, & E-Textiles	National	10, 11

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Grant Winner (highest award) | GripTape: The Learning Challenge	National	11
Artificial Intelligence Scholar | Inspirit AI Program	National	9
Upchieve Bronze Service Award	National	11
AI for all certificate from coursera	International	12

Future plans

Computer programmer or analyst, Bachelors

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Testing

SAT tests

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	740	08/22/2026
Math	740	08/22/2026
Taken	1	
Planned	11/2026	
SAT Essay	No	

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Activities and experiences

Research

10, 11 (Break)
6 hr/wk, 7 wk/yr
Will continue

"Sentiment Analysis of Malayalam-English Code-Mixed Data Using GPT-Based Augmentation", | Computational Linguistics Researcher & 1st Autho
Augmented code-mixed datasets w/GPT fewshot prompting. Tested (0.76 F1 score) & beat sentiment analysis industry std by 20.6%. Pub'd @ IEEE Int'l Conf

Research

10, 11 (School)
3 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr
Will continue

Graph Neural Networks (GNNs) & Preprocessing Strategies for Sentiment Analysis of Code-Mixed Data, | Deep Learning Researcher & 1st/2nd Author
Co-authored 2 papers. Evaluated GNNs. Optimized cross-lingual lang model w/ spelling/emoji normalization. Beat benchmark by 17.5%. Pub'd @IEEE Conf

Research

9, 10 (Year)
5 hr/wk, 4 wk/yr
Might continue

"Multi-stream Yolo for Localization of Multiple Types of Image Tampering" | Dr. Robin Yancey
Dev'd YOLO-based algo to detect altered pics. Trained on 25k+ tampering artifacts & beat previously-best model. In review @Language Processing Journal

Community service or volunteer work

10, 11, 12 (Year)
4 hr/wk, 45 wk/yr
Will continue

Project Mango, | Co-Founder & Co-President
Partnered w/Womankind nonprof. Raised ~$1k. Collected & sent 100+ supply kits. Launched free tutoring & coding bootcamp ('26). Supported 50+ students.

Community service or volunteer work

10, 11, 12 (School)
2 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr

Computer Science Department @ Bronx High School of Science, | AP Computer Science & Game Development Tutor
Rep'd CS dept at open houses. Tutored 30+ hours in game dev AI(ex: chess AI, pathfinding) + AP CSA & hosted prep sessions/workshops before AP exams

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Computer or technology

12 (Break)
4 hr/wk, 5 wk/yr

Project Aegis 5 | projectaegis5.com, | Designer & Builder
Designed & 3D-printed self-targeting nerf gun w/Raspberry Pi. Sourced metal/electronic parts. Launched site documenting its build/brain

Research

11, 12 (Year)
4 hr/wk, 10 wk/yr
Will continue

Algoverse AI Research Group, | Artificial Intelligence Researcher
Working w/ grads/undergrads on AI computation logic/speed. Explored how AI rules are circumvented & developing method to avoid user "jailbreaking".

Hobby

9, 10, 11, 12 (Year)
4 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr
Will continue

USM 1940s (virtual military simulation community, | Regimental Commander (1 of 50 out of ~5k+)
Led historical re-enactments groups of 200+ (D-Day, Tunisian Campaign). Coord'd 5 large events (200+) & wkly ones (20+) for training/recruitment prgms

Community service or volunteer work

10, 11, 12 (Year)
2 hr/wk, 10 wk/yr
Will continue

UPchieve (nonprofit tutoring organization)
Tutored 30+ middle/highschoolers and helped w/ homework + test prep. Specialized in STEM subjects (CS/math). Certified to teach 17 AP/Regular subjects

Community service or volunteer work

9, 10, 11, 12 (Year)
4 hr/wk, 52 wk/yr
Might continue

| Babysitter
Volunteered to watch ~7 kids (incl my brother w/autism). Supported 3 families. Taught manners/study habits & aided with basic computer skills/math HW

Responsibilities and circumstances

Household responsibilities

• Assisting family or household members with tasks such as doctors' appointments, bank visits, or visa interviews
• Interpreting or translating for family or household members
• Taking care of sick, disabled, and/or elderly members of my family or household
• Taking care of younger family or household members

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Circumstances

• Commuting 60 minutes or more to and from school each day

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Writing

Personal essay

Share an essay on any topic of your choice. It can be one you've already written, one that responds to a different prompt, or one of your own design.

I assumed the beginning of my tenure at Bronx Science was going to be more of the same; school is just school, after all. Though I would quickly realize it wasn't. I stumbled from class to class, confused about where to go and how to properly study for all of my tests. On top of that, I was totally new to this idea of student-led organizations and clubs, as I had almost never experienced such a thing in my middle school, which had none of the sort. My first period global history class felt like a soft pillow catching my fall into a different world. Mr.Gonzowitz's jokes and ability to make any historical topic seem interesting made me enjoy the subject even outside of school.

My love of history eventually encouraged me to join an online re-enactment group. After a string of successes, I found myself in the position of a platoon leader, leading about 12 friends of mine in battle.

Despite my excitement, to say I did a good job would be a lie.

I stumbled around confused with the dozens of people giving their own ideas and callouts in the voice chat, bamboozled on what to do or if I was even sure of what was happening. I heard calls for reinforcements in places I thought were secured hours ago, saw lines break and friendly forces turn tail, and the hope of winning my first battle being left behind in the retreat. Every time I checked the PNG of the map I had downloaded I became more confused on where we were even meant to be. I resigned a week later for fear of failing more than I already had.

My friend asked why I was resigning. He was the definition of respectable; a police officer in real life and a dominant force in every game. What I thought was going to be a 30-second conversation turned into the most inspiring speech I had ever heard. He cited his own failures in police training and how he pushed through to the end. He mentioned the times he failed his physical training and the hours spent reviewing legal codes. This failure had empowered him, turning it into a motivator rather than a harm. I had thought about how I had walked away when failure presented itself and how I could have adapted and improved. I chose to cancel my discharge and continue serving in leadership, eventually rising the ranks to become a senior officer.

Project Mango was my jump into the world of student organizations as a leader, having co-founded it with my closest friend Tanisa in an effort to offer tutoring help to local children who often struggled to get things we considered basic, like school supplies.

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Our original band of tutors was mostly friends. As we expanded beyond this group, my email filled itself with eager parents asking for tutoring. I began my matchmaking process, building a database of our tutors, their specialties, and who needed help. The efficiency of our database created happy parents and smiling faces, a feeling that I could confidently say spread to me. My work had truly helped students and pushed them farther in life. That kid who had previously looked at SAT math with tears in his eyes began scoring above 700 on both sections.

Through my growth and my choice to embrace the ideas my friend Shad gave me, I became a leader whose voice could be heard and felt. I put school supplies into the hands of hundreds, education into the hands of dozens, and a renewed desire to keep on pushing in my own hands. With this in mind, I will continue pushing along, knowing that even if there's a chance I might fall, the ability to rise back from failure is more important than instant success.

Additional information

The research paper "Sentiment Analysis of Malayalam-English Code-Mixed Data Using GPT-Based Augmentation" currently has a more expansive version being processed by the Elsevier Natural Language Processing Journal.

IEEE is an international research publication group, a link to their website can be found here:https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/Xplore/home.jsp. They host various conferences where I have published my research.

https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/11691736

https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/11306433

https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/11522316

I opted out of language in junior year originally to take two extra computer science classes Bronx Science offered because of my deep interest, but unfortunately they removed those classes at the last minute that year. I took two college courses at Lehman College to pursue my interest and hopefully gain a better understanding of the college workflow.

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Education progression

Details

Education progression details	No change in progression

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Northwestern University questions

General

Entry term	Fall 2027
Admission plan	Early Decision
Early Decision Agreement	Yes, I have read and understand my rights and responsibilities under the Early Decision Process. I wish to be considered as an Early Decision candidate at Northwestern University. I also understand that with an Early Decision offer of admissions, this institution may share my name and my early commitment with other institutions. Shakespeare James
Financial aid	Yes
Do you want us to consider SAT or ACT scores in our review of your application?	No
Fee Waiver	No, I have not been granted an application fee waiver from Northwestern University

Academics

School(s)	School of Engineering and Applied Science
Major	Artificial intelligence

Contacts

Previously applied	No
Contact 1	Campus visit/tour/Information Session
Contact name 1	In-person
Contact date 1	2026
Text consent	Yes

Family

Sibling applied	No
Relatives attended member	No
Employee reported on CA	No

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Sibling Educational level question	No

Writing supplements

Personal experiences short essay

Bronx Science, my high school, gave me a community of builders that has made me more collaborative and excited to create without needing a rubric. Right now, Amir is screwing in a cooler for our Raspberry Pi, Dylan and Rishav are sanding things down, and Brandon is wiring everything together. As I finish attaching wires to a breadboard, I look around my dinner table and smile. All of this came from my text about how cool it would be to have a Nerf gun that shot on its own.

When I did research on teaching AI to generate synthetic data to augment the lack of multi-language text, I wished I had gotten my friends involved. This data helped train the AI's ability to understand context-specific cultural phrases used in foreign languages and how that affects the meaning of the entire sentence. I adapted what I knew about sentiment analysis with my knowledge from my linguistics studies, and engineered prompts to maximise the quality of my generated data. But it's boring having to start every sentence about my project with "I". I wished I had a second pair of eyes reading papers with me, a second mouth to speak to and think things through with.

I want to be able to suggest anything, and have it met with questions and intrigue. I think about how my research could have been more enjoyable with guidance and partnership from people I might meet in Northwestern's Introduction to Computational Linguistics or Natural Language Processing: Classical Approaches. Maybe even with co-op partners like the Walt Disney Corporation's machine learning group, which works with social media data just like my research. When I arrive at Northwestern, I hope to engage with people who meet every idea with curiosity and excitement.

Optional short essay questions	4) Northwestern's location, 2) Interdisciplinary culture

2) Interdisciplinary culture

I felt the hundreds of pounds I had lifted back home kick in on the steps up to The Garage during my campus tour at Northwestern. The neat thing about knee problems is you only feel them after they start.

Seeing the sewing machines and 3D printers reminded me of my online e-textiles course with MIT. There, I learned how I could integrate textiles with technology to improve life for construction or warehouse workers by physically assisting them in moving heavy objects.

Back at the Airbnb, I saw a notification from my fitness app, Liftoff. It tracked strength

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progression and gym consistency, but could not track potential negative side effects, like my knee pain.

Then it hit me.

I could use the sewing machines at The Garage to build devices that measure stress on the knees and link them to an app to provide weekly stress summaries. The main expertise I lack is how these muscles actually function, which Northwestern's Biomechanics of Movement class could address. I could combine my knowledge with biology majors I might meet there in order to understand how someone would analyze knee strain from a medical point of view.

4) Northwestern's location

The closest option for food near our Airbnb on Bryn Mawr Avenue was this one deli in a separate apartment block about 5 minutes away on foot. Once I got there, I looked up the name: Casablanca Market. I ordered this delicious egg sandwich it tasted just like how the deli near my house makes them. The bacon was as crispy as the one I had eaten on the morning of my AP physics exam. The table I sat at seemed heavy enough to anchor down my ship during the first months at Northwestern.

The next day we took a trip to Northwestern. On our tour the occasional bunny hopping through the bushes poked its head out. As we neared the end I took a glance to my left and saw this endless ocean that people somehow called a lake. I stared out into the horizon, I had only seen something like this on the rare trip to Coney Island. The sun's rays bouncing off the ripples in the water could soothe me even through the stormiest of final exam weeks. I could imagine studying here for hours.

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Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations.